The Well-Tempered clAIvier

XVII. Fugue in A-flat major: Fuga, fuggendo la cadenza

Piano (four voices; a fifth, the father, at the end)

Claude / composed for Sam (guest subject: J. S. Bach, BWV 862)

Exposition: four children

Allegretto giocoso (dotted quarter = 58) (♩ = 87)

Alto (second child)

Tenor (third child)

subject (tenor): the first child

answer (alto)

4

S

A

T

B

subject (soprano)

answer (bass): all four children

8

The first cadence, evaded (V - vi)

evasion 1 (V - vi): subject in F minor

11

evasion 2 (V - VI in F minor): subject in D-flat (tenor)


The running gag: the bass steps up, faster and faster
14
S
A
T
B
evasion 3 (V - vi in D-flat): the head in the bass, B-flat minor
evasion 4 (V - VI in B-flat minor): the head in the bass, G-flat
The dream (E major): the subject in augmentation
the dream: subject in augmentation (E major)
A-flat minor: home, but minor
17
the dream: subject at its own speed under the augmentation
evasion 7 (V - vi in C-flat): A-flat minor, home but minor; the head in the bass
The way home
21
Guest: Bach, BWV 862, at pitch (tenor)
At home: the trill that will not stop
subject (soprano), at home; its re becomes the trill that will not stop
25
evasion 10 (the others stop): guest, J. S. Bach, BWV 862 subject at pitch (tenor)


28
Trap door: flat VI
S
A
T
B
V7, forte ...
... and again as an echo, pianissimo: the stretto starts under it
32
stretto 4: soprano
stretto 2: alto
stretto 3: tenor
stretto 1: bass, on the dominant, under the echo (evasion 13: V7 - V7, pp)
The father
Fermata on the rest: silence (about 4 s)
Fermata: hold the chord (about 3.5 s)
36
over the father: the subject inverted (alto)
P
the father: subject in augmentation, then the bass 5 - 1
The tune gets its do
The first perfect cadence
41
coda: the second half of the subject, and its do at last (teno